# Attacking transfers: why do they often fail?

Usage, playing time and luck after a move, Big-5, 2014–15 to 2024–25

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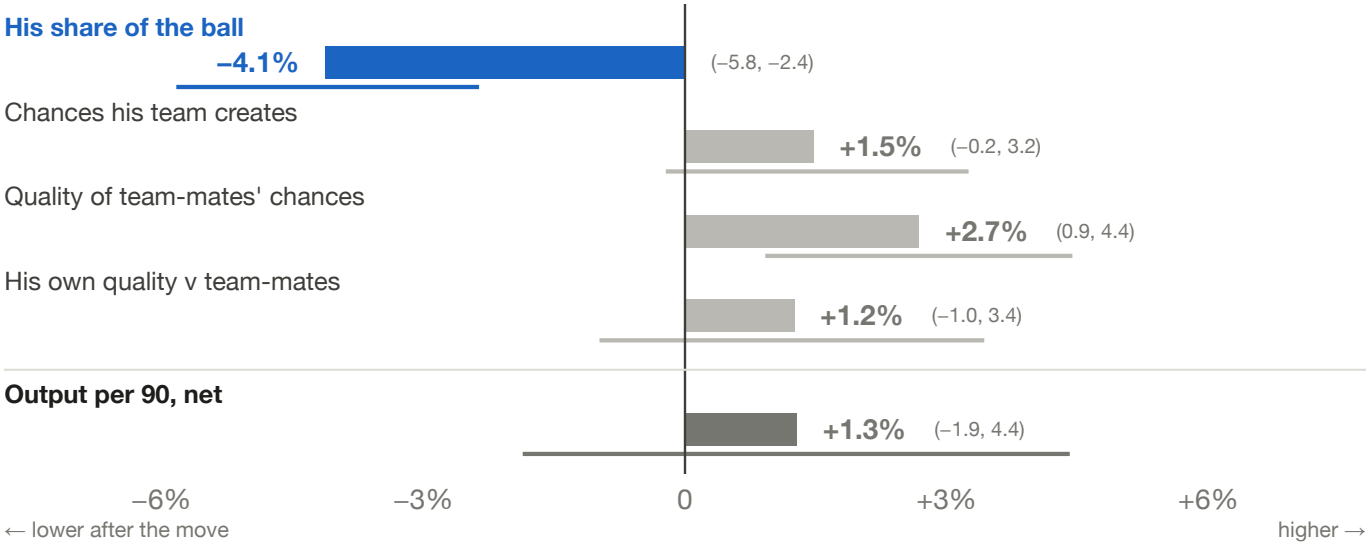
After a move between Big-5 clubs, an attacker is +11.7 points (7.9, 15.4) more likely to flop or lose his place than a stayer with the same last season; without moves Transfermarkt records no fee for, which may carry hindsight, +5.4 (0.9, 9.6). Paid and free moves cannot yet be told apart. He starts 8.2 points fewer of his first 10 matches after joining. If he keeps his place, output per 90 changes by +1.3% (–1.9, 4.4). Observational and exploratory.

**+11.7 pts**
flop or lost his place, movers v stayers, matched

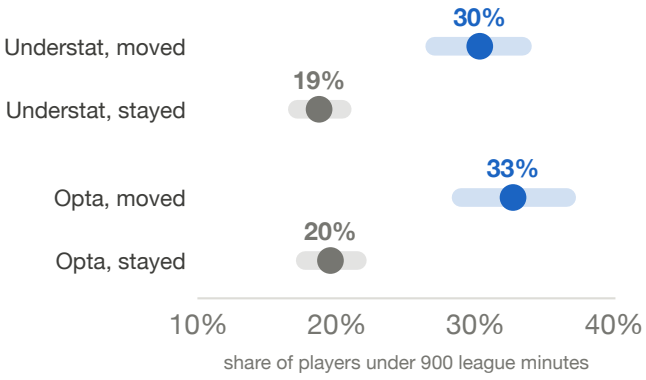
**30% v 19%**
under 900 league minutes next season, movers v stayers

**–8.2 pts**
starts in 10 matches from first squad, matched

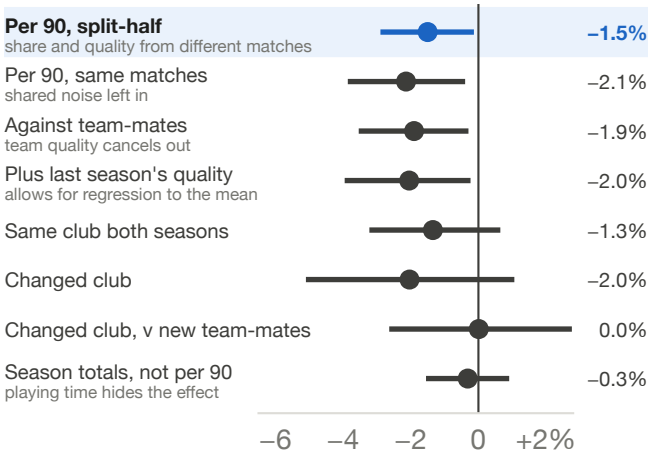
## What a move does, against stayers with the same last season (per 90)



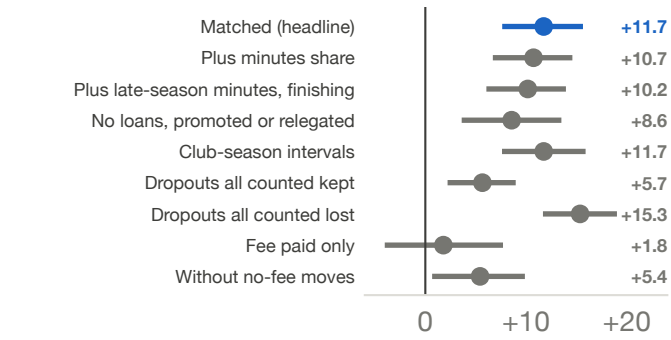

## Below 900 league minutes the next season



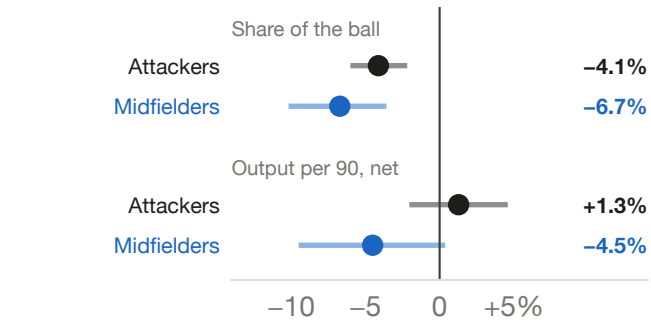

## Same player, 5 points more of the ball




## Flop or lost place under each check (points)




## After a move: attackers v midfielders (matched)




Limits: observational and exploratory, nothing pre-registered; shots and shot-assists only; the four-part split is accounting; no betting, fantasy or prop market tested, so no trading signal. Big-5: top divisions of England, Spain, Italy, Germany, France.
Data: Understat, Opta via FBref, Transfermarkt. 95% intervals.

github.com/benedictprimmer-web/football-usage-efficiency